

IC Critique

This is how a tough IC will actually pressure-test this deal.

1. “This Sounds Like Every Trading AI Pitch Ever”

You claim a learning-loop moat, but there’s no hard evidence yet that:

- Models materially outperform baseline behavior
- Improvements persist across market regimes
- Brokers can’t replicate this internally

IC Concern:

Until performance data is undeniable, this is a *hypothesis*, not a moat.

2. “Where Is the Proof That Traders Actually Do Better?”

User feedback is not the same as outcome improvement.

Missing:

- PnL deltas
- Drawdown reduction
- Risk-adjusted performance metrics
- Retention curves tied to performance

IC View:

If you can’t quantify improved outcomes, you’re selling vibes, not value.

3. “Brokers Say Yes to Pilots All the Time”

A pipeline slide is not traction.

Key questions:

- How many brokers are live vs evaluating?
- Who has signed contracts?
- Who is paying vs experimenting?
- How long is the sales cycle really?

IC Red Flag:

If this is pilot-heavy, revenue-light, time-to-scale may be much longer than projected.

4. “Two-Sided Incentives Are Fragile”

You’re serving traders *and* brokers. Those incentives diverge fast.

- Traders want best execution and neutrality
- Brokers want volume, retention, and monetization

IC Fear:

The moment traders suspect bias, trust collapses. The moment brokers don’t see revenue lift, budgets disappear.

5. “Regulatory Risk Is Being Hand-Waved”

Trading intelligence lives in a gray zone.

Unclear:

- Are you a signal provider?
- An execution layer?
- A behavioral analytics tool?

IC Concern:

One regulator forcing reclassification could blow up the model or slow adoption dramatically.

6. “This Is a Nice Product — Is It a Venture-Scale Company?”

Even if this works:

- How big is the broker revenue opportunity?
- How many brokers realistically adopt?
- Does this cap out as a \$20–50M revenue business?

IC Question:

Where does this get *non-linearly large*?

What Would Turn a Skeptic Into a Believer

From an IC standpoint, **one slide** could change everything:

“Traders using Vibe Trader improved X% on metric Y over Z trades, sustained over N months.”

Secondarily:

- One broker paying meaningful dollars
- One case study showing retention or LTV lift
- One clear regulatory positioning statement